CORE FALSE BELIEF #11 · OTHER PEOPLE

“Nobody loves me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

This belief can grow from a childhood without warmth or affection, the loss of a spouse or parent, a painful breakup, or long seasons of loneliness. Depression can also color everything gray, so that even real love is hard to feel. When people feel unloved, they may withdraw, which leads to more loneliness and seems to prove the belief true.

What Scripture teaches

The Bible declares that God has loved His people with an everlasting love. John marvels at the kind of love the Father has given, that we should be called children of God. Jesus said that as the Father loved Him, so He loves us. Even if mountains are shaken, God’s loving devotion will not depart. Human love may be missing or imperfect right now, but you are loved by God fully and personally. That love can also open your eyes to the people who do care for you.

> *“Behold what manner of love the Father has given to us, that we should be called children of God. And that is what we are! The reason the world does not know us is that it did not know Him”* (1 John 3:1).

Also see

> “The LORD appeared to us in the past, saying: ‘I have loved you with an everlasting love; therefore I have drawn you with loving devotion.’” (Jeremiah 31:3).

> “As the Father has loved Me, so have I loved you. Remain in My love” (John 15:9).

> “Though the mountains may be removed and the hills may be shaken, My loving devotion will not depart from you, and My covenant of peace will not be broken, says the LORD, who has compassion on you” (Isaiah 54:10).

> “As a father has compassion on his children, so the LORD has compassion on those who fear Him” (Psalm 103:13).

Common self-statements

- No one cares about me.
- If I died, no one would miss me.
- Everyone else is loved but me.
- People are nice to me only out of obligation.
- I’m completely alone.
- Even God doesn’t love me.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralization: Using “nobody” and “never” when some people do care.
- Emotional reasoning: Believing I am unloved because I feel unloved.
- Discounting the positive: Explaining away kindness as obligation.
- Mental filter: Focusing on who doesn’t love me and overlooking who does.

Challenging questions

- Is it true that nobody loves me, or that I don’t feel loved right now?

- Who has shown me care, even in small ways?
- Am I withdrawing in ways that make love harder to find?
- Could sadness or depression be affecting how I see things?
- What does God say about His love for me?
- What is one small step toward connection?

Truth summary

> I feel unloved right now, and that is painful. But feelings are not the full truth. God has loved me with an everlasting love and calls me His child. I can look for the ways I am cared for and take small steps toward people.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Love, By God
- Loneliness
- God, All Loving
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Friendship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Depression

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Good Good Father — Chris Tomlin
God's fatherly love is deeper than human approval or achievement.

More Than Conquerors — Steven Curtis Chapman
Christ's saving work answers condemnation, shame, and fear of separation from God.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Nobody loves me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Nobody loves me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Is it true nobody loves me, or that I don't feel loved?
- ☐ Who has shown me care?
- ☐ Am I withdrawing?
- ☐ Could sadness be affecting how I see things?
- ☐ What does God say about His love?
- ☐ What small step toward connection can I take?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God has loved me with an everlasting love.
- ☐ I am called a child of God.
- ☐ Jesus loves me as the Father loves Him.
- ☐ Feeling unloved is not the same as being unloved.
- ☐ Some people do care about me.
- ☐ God's love will not depart from me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 John 3:1
  "Behold what manner of love the Father has given to us, that we should be called children of God. And that is what we are! The reason the world does not know us is that it did not know Him."
- ☐ Jeremiah 31:3
  "The LORD appeared to us in the past, saying: 'I have loved you with an everlasting love; therefore I have drawn you with loving devotion.'"
- ☐ John 15:9
  "As the Father has loved Me, so have I loved you. Remain in My love."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Signs of love today: Each evening, write one sign of love or care you noticed today, from God or from a person.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 John 3:1 becomes: "Linda can write: "The Father has lavished His love on me. I am called His child, and that is what I am.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Love, By God" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ Look for evidence. Write the names of people who have shown you any kindness in the last year. Ask yourself what each act says.
- ☐ Reach out once. Send one message or make one call to someone you care about this week.
- ☐ Read God's love letter. Read 1 John 3:1 and Jeremiah 31:3 each morning and say, "This is true of me."
- ☐ Get support for heavy sadness. If feeling unloved comes with deep sadness that won't lift, talk with a doctor, pastor, or counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie “Nobody loves me”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A sign of love I noticed
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Nobody loves me.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I feel so unloved and alone. Thank You that You have loved me with an everlasting love and call me Your child. Open my eyes to Your love and to the people who care about me, and give me courage to reach out. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.